

UTT Chapter 09 Assignment

Hello!

Finals are quickly approaching, so I am spending most of my time in the library. Nothing has changed too much since I last wrote except for my coffee consumption. Let's just say if I were to bleed, I'm pretty sure I would bleed espresso. Honestly though, I'm not too worried about most of my finals, but Art History has a really long paper due in a few days. Paige and I are going to meet up tomorrow so she can help me put together a decent paper. She is the one really interested in postmodern art.

In other news, I went back home this weekend to visit my family. It was awesome eating homemade food instead of the dining hall chow I am usually subject to. Nothing beats Mom's homemade lemon meringue pie. It also gave me a chance to catch up on sleep. I hadn't realized how tired I was. Now I am all rested, armed with several dozen chocolate chip cookies, ready to take on finals next week.

While at home, I registered for a philosophy class with Sarah and Mark for next semester. We checked out some of the required texts, and it looks like I have a lot of difficult reading ahead of me! At book club yesterday, we already started discussing some of the concepts we will cover in class. Have you ever heard of some of these terms: *metaphysics*, *epistemology*, *ontology*, and *epiphenomenalism*? I had no idea that philosophy would be so complicated.

I also didn't realize that philosophy could be so divisive. My friends at book club all had different opinions over the subject. Sarah said the only way to know anything is by the scientific method. She argued that nothing about the immaterial or supernatural could be known since it was outside the realm of scientific inquiry. Mark seemed to agree until Sarah said there is no inherent purpose in the world. Mark responded that history does have a purpose, and the world is gradually progressing toward economic equality. Nathan piped up saying we there is purpose, but took issue with the idea that matter is all there is. Paige declared the whole conversation pointless since we are all constrained by our own experiences. All the while, I am sitting there just trying to follow what everyone was saying.

After a while, though, I had to go study. I left more confused than when I arrived. Maybe you can help me! Sarah and Mark appear to agree on a lot, but they obviously have some different thoughts on philosophy. **How do Marxism and Secularism differ in their views on philosophy?** Paige didn't really talk about what she thought. **What is the philosophical position of Postmodernism?** As usual, Mark has some strange things to say. **What are the philosophical views of New Spirituality?** After these conversations, I am confused about what I am supposed to think as a Christian about philosophy. **What does Christianity have to say about philosophy?**

I really appreciate your help! You rock!

Later!

-Doug